SpeechGeek



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You may be wondering what's up with the photo of the girl in short sleeves on the cover of the Winter 2007 issue. Oh, you didn't? Well, go ahead and ask yourself that question, otherwise this little rant won't make sense. Question posed? Good. Winter brings to mind cold weather (for most of the country, at least). It's also one of the busiest parts of the competitive forensics season. It's that time of year where things begin to come together: you get a feel for your character, the blocking of your duo is finally solid, and you've (at last!) learned to go to bed early the night before a tournament rather than run that intro one last time. Well, you may want to run the intro once more. It was kind of shaky in practice rounds the other day.

We're happy to welcome Paul Davis back for his second season providing some challenging and wonderful scripts. Paul is an out-there kind of guy, but his scripts pack a punch!.

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

p.s. I honestly don't know why she has on short sleeves. She's probably from Texas. Wait a minute, I know she's from Texas. Whew! I knew there was an explanation somewhere.

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CHILD. (*singing*) *O-o-h child things are gonna get easier*
O-o-h child things'll get brighter
O-o-h child things are gonna—can we sing something else now?

CHARLIE. No. You can't move on until you get this song right. Now keep going. (*Hums the tune*)

CHILD. *Someday we'll walk in the rays of a beautiful sun*
Someday when the world is much lighter—I think our time is up for the lesson.

CHARLIE. It's not over yet, Steven. This isn't even your designated lesson time, so we end when I say.

CHILD. But when you picked me up walking home from school, you just said you needed to swing by your house really quick before you dropped me off.

CHARLIE. Right, so I could see how you're coming along. (*He reaches out to run his fingers through the child's hair*)

CHILD. Can I go home now?

CHARLIE. No…not yet.

COP. (*banging on the door*) Charlie! Open up, this is the police.

CHARLIE. (*he opens the door*) Hey Phil. What's going on?

COP. Sorry Charlie, I'm here as a cop, not a friend. Another child has disappeared.

CHARLIE. That's terrible. Who was it?

COP. Steven Banks.

CHARLIE. Steven? You're kidding.

COP. No, I'm not. Some parents of the children that you give private music lessons to are starting to get concerned.

CHARLIE. What?

COP. Nobody is pointing any fingers yet, but the first three children to disappear were all students of yours.

CHARLIE. That's ridiculous! They were all in the same class together too. They all went to the same stores, they all live in the same neighborhood. It's not like any of them went to a music lesson and never came home or anything. They always got home safe when we were done.

COP. Chuck, calm down. No one is saying you did anything. We're going to search those places too. But right now I just need to look around your house if that's alright.

CHARLIE. Now?

COP. Well, since I'm here, I thought it might be kind of convenient.

CHARLIE. Yeah, alright.

COP. Thanks. I tried explaining to the parents that you were a totally normal guy. You've just been a little off since…your mother disappeared.

CHARLIE. Phil. You think I'm a little off?

COP. Well, you were raised by just your mother, right? No siblings or father or anything?

CHARLIE. That's right; it was just me and her.

CHARLIE BOY. Sing it one more time, Mom.

MOM. Charlie Boy, it's getting late.

CHARLIE BOY. Just one more time. Please.

MOM. *O-o-h child, things are gonna get easier*

CHARLIE. (*eyes closed, humming in a daze*)
COP. Charlie.
CHARLIE. Huh?
COP. I was just saying that being raised by just your mother for eighteen years and then her disappearing out of nowhere would be dramatic for anyone.
CHARLIE. Yeah. It was hard.
COP. I mean, we all assumed that it was that guy she met, but we could never find enough evidence to bring him up on it.
CHARLIE. The worst was just not knowing what happened to her.

MOM. Charlie Boy. You're eighteen years old now, so I think that you can handle the news I'm about to tell you. When I was raising you, I wasn't looking for anybody, but now that you're almost all grown up, I want someone to spend my time with.
CHARLIE BOY. Don't you want to spend time with me?
MOM. Yes honey, but I've also met someone.
CHARLIE BOY. What? Are you leaving me?
MOM. No, of course not. I just need someone to love.
CHARLIE BOY. Don't you love me?
MOM. Of course I do. I just get lonely. I need love that you can't give me.
CHARLIE BOY. Who am I gonna spend my time with?
MOM. Charlie, you're eighteen, you need to make some friends.
CHARLIE BOY. I'm not gonna let someone take you away from me!
MOM. Charlie, don't talk to me that way. Nobody is going to take me away from you. You're just going to have to share my love with someone else.
CHARLIE BOY. I can't.
MOM. Well, you're going to have to.

COP. Well, Charlie, everything here looks normal. Just one more thing. That trunk on the floor there. Can you pop it open for me?
CHARLIE. It's what's left of my mother...all her belongings. I don't really like to open it.
COP. Well...I understand. Thanks for your time Chuck.
CHARLIE. Yeah, one sec. (*he turns to answer the phone*) Hello? Hello? (*he hangs up and turns back to the cop*) Must've been a wrong number.
COP. Did your phone ring, Charlie?
CHARLIE. Yeah, that's why I answered it. Check your hearing Phil.
COP. I guess I need to. Okay, well, see you in church on Sunday.
CHARLIE. Bye. (*He closes the door and then turns to answer the phone again*) Hello?
MOM. Hi, Charlie Boy.
CHARLIE. Who is this?
MOM. Charlie Boy, don't you recognize your own mother's voice.
CHARLIE. Yeah...but you're dead.
MOM. But you're the only one who knows that.
CHARLIE. What do you want!?
MOM. I just want to see my boy.
CHARLIE. Well you can't!
MOM. Of course I can.
CHARLIE. Go away! I can't do it again. I have to stop. You have to leave me alone.
MOM. You have to give me the boy. Then I'll leave you alone. But first I need another child.
CHARLIE. He's already with you.
MOM. He can't be alive, Charlie Boy.
CHARLIE. I don't want to anymore.

MOM. You don't have a choice.

CHARLIE. You're not real. You're just in my head!

MOM. Maybe. But that's the most dangerous place for me to be. You shouldn't have killed me Charlie Boy. Now you have to keep killing if you want me to leave you alone. Give him to me and I'll go.

CHARLIE. Fine, just get away from me! Leave me alone! Get out! Go away. Just leave me alone and I'll do it.

(*Charlie opens up the trunk and the child is inside*)

CHARLIE. Wake up.

CHILD. It's really hard to breathe in here.

CHARLIE. That's because you weren't entirely alone. You got to know my mother a little better.

CHILD. There's nothing else in this trunk but dust and rocks.

CHARLIE. Those aren't rocks. That's what happens over time.

CHILD. What?

CHARLIE. Never mind. Come on out of there. (*He lifts the child from the trunk)*

CHILD. I was quiet just like you told me to be.

CHARLIE. Yes you were. (*He sets the child down so he's standing upright*) Here, stand up.

CHILD. Can I go home now? My mom's gonna be worried sick.

CHARLIE. Soon, but first I have to show you one more thing. (*Charlie turns around, pulls out a large knife and turns back to the child*)

CHILD. No, please. You promised.

CHARLIE. I can't just let you go. I have to give you to my mother. She wants another child.

CHILD. What?

CHARLIE. She won't leave me alone until she gets another child. And eventually, she will want another, but right now you are enough. Sing for me Steven. It makes it so much easier.

CHILD. No.

CHARLIE. *O-o-h child thing are gonna get easier.*

CHILD. No, please don't hurt me. (*The child starts to back up in fear*) Let me go home. Don't hurt me. You said you'd let me go.

CHARLIE. (*Singing and walking forward, near tears) Someday we'll walk in the rays of a beautiful sun. Someday when the world is much lighter.* (*He stops in front of the child*) Goodbye Steven. You belong to her now. (*He drives the knife into the child*) I'm sorry. (*He cradles the child*) Shhh. Don't cry. (*He pulls the knife out...*) I'm so sorry. (*And plunges it into the child again*) Shh, don't cry. Quiet now, it's over. See? (*He pulls the knife out and throws it aside. He just cradles the child and rocks him gently until he dies*) It's over, be quiet. Shh. Don't cry, it's over. That's right, just close your eyes. It's over now. It's all over.